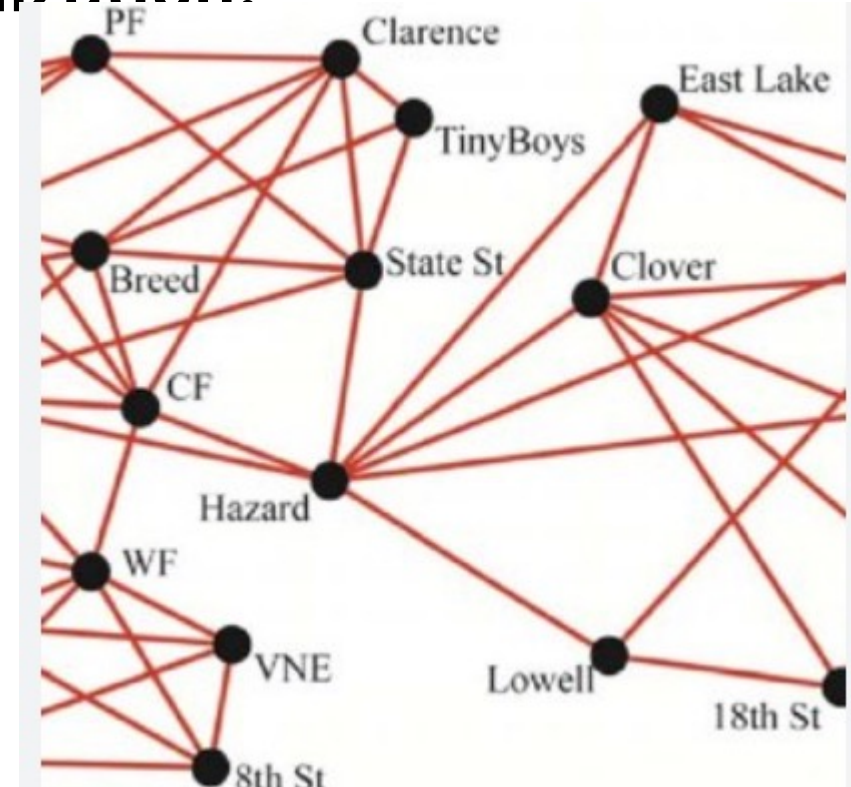


Theories of Victimization



Equivalent group hypothesis

- States that victims and criminals are part of the same social groups, and that criminal involvement or association with a criminal lifestyle increases one's risk of victimization.
- Today, we call this “victim-offender overlap”
- Example of this: network analysis shows that young males who are shot in drive-bys and similar events are often victims as a result of their involvement in gangs





Crime In NYC ✓

@CrimeInNYC



A 13-year-old Crown Heights boy who was shot on his way home from a Nets game was targeted for his affiliation with a street gang.

Troy Gill was a member of the Trench Crew and was gunned down by members of a rival gang at Brooklyn Avenue and St. Marks Avenue around 10 p.m. Thursday.

“He was definitely targeted,” a police source said, adding that cops have video of members of the rival crew.

He was alone when he was shot four times, in the chest and arm.

Lifestyle Exposure Theory

- **Developed by Hindelang, Gottfredson, and Garofalo (1978)**
- **originally proposed to account for differences in risks of violent victimization across different social groups**
- **demographic differences in the likelihood of victimization are attributed to differences in the personal lifestyles of victims. Lifestyle factors account for differences in exposure to dangerous places, people, and times.**
- **Some situations are going to come with a higher risk of victimization.**

- **Lifestyle is as "routine daily activities, both vocational activities (work, school, keeping house, etc.) and leisure activities" (Hindelang, Gottfredson, and Garofalo 1978, p. 241).**
- **People's daily activities may naturally bring them into contact with crime, or they merely increase the risk of crime.**
- **Time spent in one's home generally decreases victim risk, while time spent in public settings increases risk.**
- **Let's compare the differences in lifestyle between 20-year-old Professor Huey to 50-year-old Professor Huey**

20 Year Old Professor Huey



50 Year Old Professor Huey



Post



Dr. Laura Huey

@DrLauraHuey



We interrupt our usual crime posting to bring you my latest “art”. If you live in London (Ontario), I periodically give things away & am willing to sell items for animal rescue donations & other good causes

Insta: Thee_Mad_Crafter



Victim Precipitation Theory

- **Earliest references to the victim role in some offending:**

"the victim-offender problem" (MacDonald 1939)

"the duet frame of crime" (Von Hentig 1948)

"the penal couple" (Ellenberger 1955)

"the victim-offender relationship" (Von Hentig 1940)

Marving Wolfgang (1950s) and “Victim Precipitation”

- **What Wolfgang was describing was instances in relation to homicide where “the victim is the first in the homicide drama to resort to physical force against the subsequent slayer” (Wolfgang 1958).**



Two types of precipitation

- **Active Precipitation:** occurs when victims act in ways that provoke or threaten another individual (such as the use of threats or fighting gestures).
- **Passive Precipitation:** happens when the victim exhibits some trait or behaviours that unknowingly threaten or provoke the attacker (such as someone from a particular economic or other social group).

Later work expanded on this idea

- **Aggravated assaults: where the victim provokes or escalates a situation through language or gestures (Curtis 1974; Miethe 1985).**
- **Robbery: those cases where the victim has failed to be cautious in the handling of money, jewelry, or other valuables – maybe flashing around cash or designer goods (Normandeau 1968; Curtis 1974)**
- **And, **controversially**, sexual assaults: which the victim first agreed to sexual relations, or clearly invited them verbally or through gestures, but then said no (Amir 1967; Curtis 1974).**

Criticisms of victim precipitation theory

- **Seen as “victim blaming” rather than explaining**
- **In relation to sexual assault, this theory has been highly problematic because it ignores very important issues around gendered and other power dynamics**
- **Treating rape as though it were similar in nature to homicide**
- **Passive precipitation could be seen as an excuse for hateful activities such as “gay bashing”**

Deviant Place Hypothesis

- States there are natural areas for crime, such as economically disadvantaged, transient neighbourhoods lacking in formal and informal social controls
- We might call this the “you live in a bad neighbourhood idea”



The Proximity Hypothesis

- **States that some people willingly put themselves in risky situations by actively choosing high risk lifestyles**
- **Or, because they are forced to live in close physical proximity to criminals (wrong place and the wrong time).**

- **Physical proximity to high-crime areas is a major factor that increases victim risk.**
- **Living in a high-crime area increases the likelihood of frequent contact with offenders and thus increases one's risks of victimization. That persons spend a majority of their time around the home and that offenders tend to select victims in close proximity to their residences (Hindelang, Gottfredson, and Garofalo 1978) further increase the adverse consequences of living in a high-crime area.**

Routine Activities Theory

- **Developed by Cohen and Felson (1979).**
- **Examples of routine activities (that you do but probably don't think much about:**

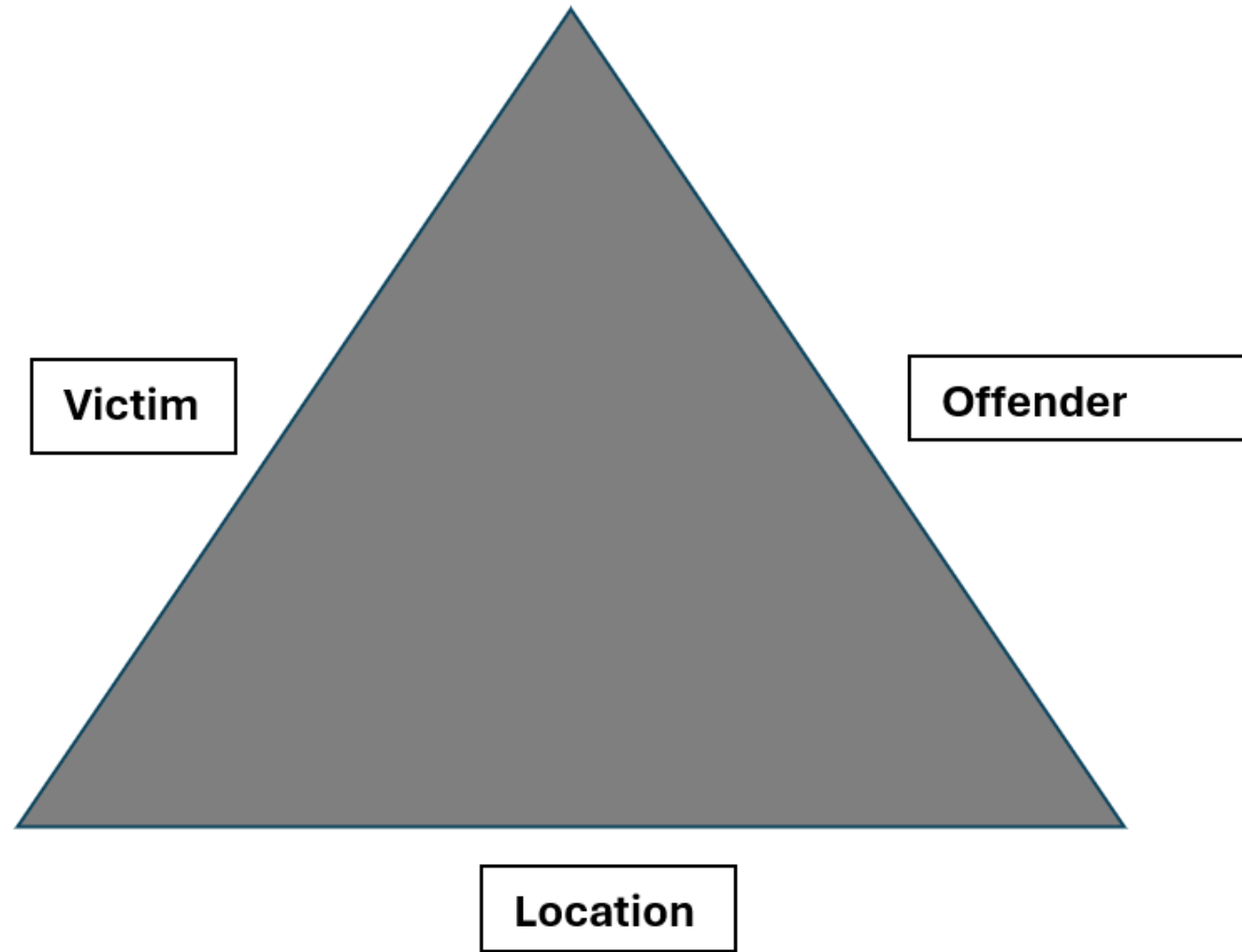
Walking your dog every morning

Going to work

Getting coffee at Starbucks on your way to class

Letting the dog out at night before going to bed

Routine Activities Theory (Cohen and Felson 1970s)



Important point about RAT theory

- Many criminologists point to structural conditions – economy, social problems, etc – as causing crime.
- Cohen & Felson point out that increases in crime rates can occur without any increase/decrease in the structural conditions that might motivate offenders ... as long as there has been an increase in the supply of attractive and unguarded targets for victimization.

Routine activity effects of the Covid-19 pandemic on burglary in Detroit, March, 2020

Felson et al. 2020

Abstract

What does this mean?

It means that burglaries increased against commercial businesses, but not in residential neighbourhoods

... **bc people were home!!**

The spread of the coronavirus has led to containment policies in many places, with concomitant shifts in routine activities. Major declines in crime have been reported as a result. However, those declines depend on crime type and may differ by parts of a city and land uses. This paper examines burglary in Detroit, Michigan during the month of March, 2020, a period of considerable change in routine activities. We examine 879 block groups, separating those dominated by residential land use from those with more mixed land use. We divide the month into three periods: pre-containment, transition period, and post-containment. Burglaries increase in block groups with mixed land use, but not blocks dominated by residential land use. The impact of containment policies on burglary clarifies after taking land use into account.

Routine Activities Theory (RAT)



Routine Activity Theories: The Basics

Alexa Maude
Canadian Society of Evidence Based Policing

all done!

